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Glottal T in Syllabic N
Words and Sentences

The /t/ and /rt/ also become a glottal stop when the final syllable is pronounced /n/ since the vowel is not even produced before the /n/ here. This phenomenon occurs in weak syllables. The syllabic /n/spellings include “tan, tain, ten, tin, and ton.” They are all produced with a glottal /t/ and a strong sustained /n/.

So, the word “bitten” would not be pronounced “bih tEn” but rather “bih (t)n.” The /t/ is not dropped but stopped in the throat. The vowel is shortened, and the /n/ will be emphasized. Here are a few examples of words ending in a syllabic /n/ that is pronounced with a glottal stop /t/:

batten:	Batten the hatches
beaten:	He was beaten up by bullies
bitten:	I was bitten by the snake
brighten:	This will brighten your day
button:	He pressed the red button
carton:	I bought a carton of milk
certain:	Are you certain about that?
cotton:	This is not made of cotton
curtain:	I have to open that curtain
Dalton:	His name was Dalton
eaten:	I haven't eaten all morning
fatten:	They fattened the cows
flatten:	They can’t flatten those boxes
forgotten:	It won’t be forgotten
fountain:	Let's meet at the fountain
frighten:	I didn't mean to frighten her

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gluten:	It’s gluten-free
gotten:	I haven't gotten the deal yet
important:	It's important
kitten:	What a cute kitten
lighten:	She did it to lighten the mood
Manhattan:	I’ve never been to Manhattan
Martin:	Martin was the leader of the group
mitten:	She lost her mittens
molten:	They saw molten lava
mountain:	I have a mountain of laundry to do
Newton:	I don’t know much about Isaac Newton
rotten:	That's a rotten tomato
satin:	I love satin pillows
shorten:	I have to shorten my presentation
straighten:	I straightened my hair today
sultan:	He was the sultan of Broadway
sweeten:	The sugar sweetened the recipe
tartan:	This is my family tartan
threaten:	How dare you threaten me
tighten:	We need to tighten that bottle
whiten:	I whitened my teeth today
written:	Where was this written?